

CS 25-337 RAMily: Creating Community Beyond the Weeks of Welcome

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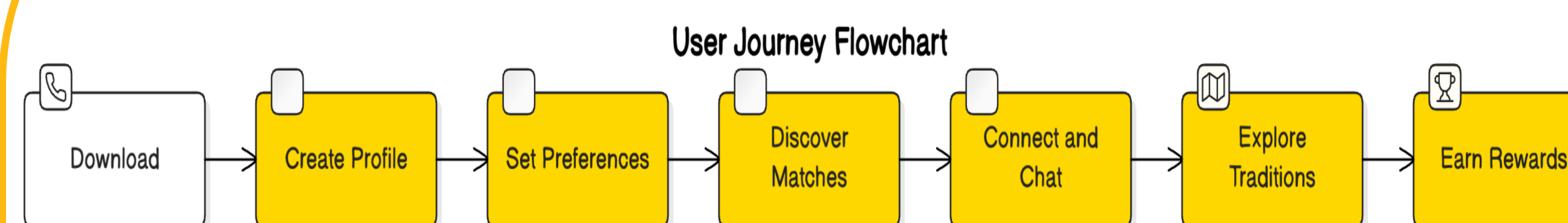
Background & Motivation

- Research by the da Vinci Center revealed that VCU students prioritize building a sense of belonging over financial literacy.
- 78% of surveyed students expressed difficulty finding connections that last beyond orientation week.
- Our team transformed the initial concept into a full-featured mobile application designed specifically to address student needs for community building.
- RAMily serves as a bridge between orientation activities and sustained campus engagement throughout student's academic careers.

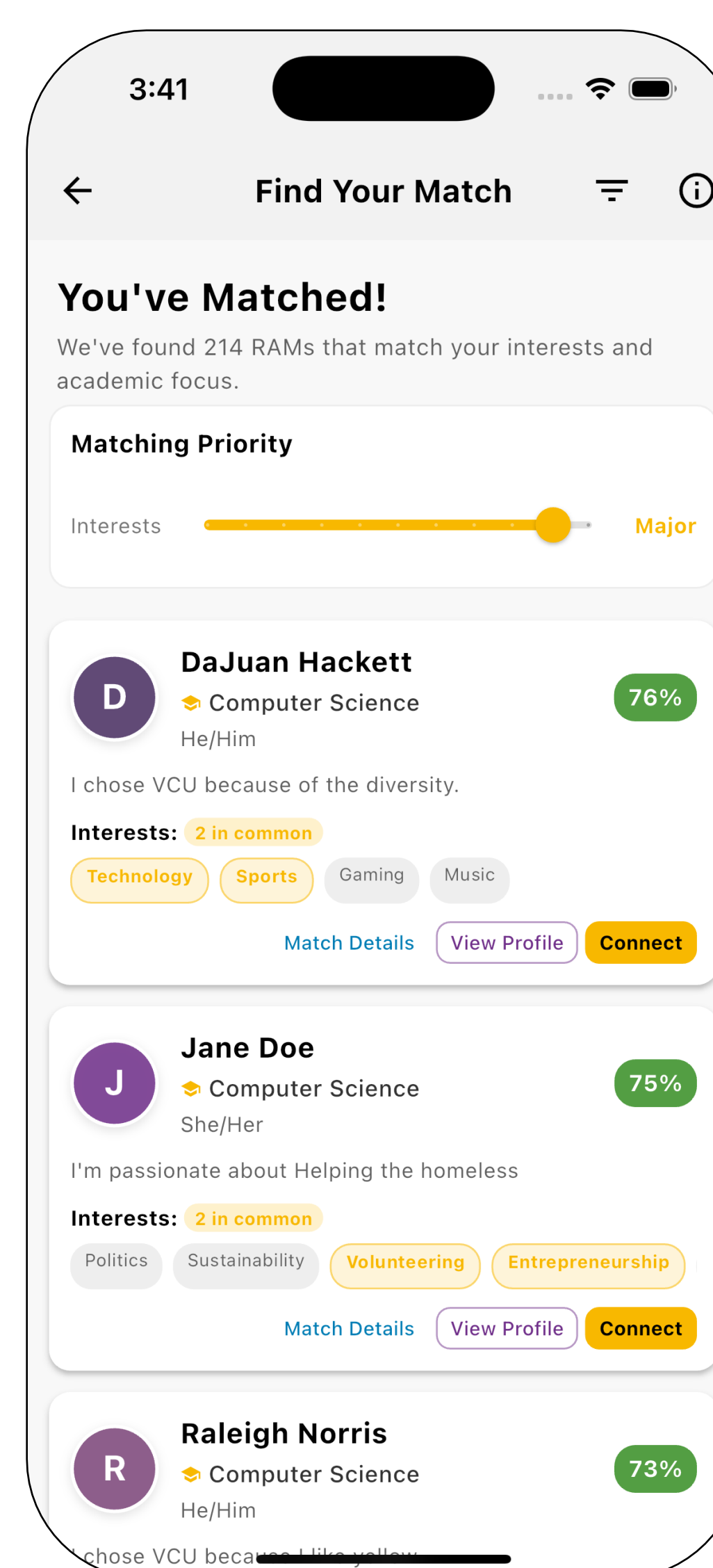
Technical Implementation

- Frontend Development:** Flutter/Dart framework enabling cross-platform compatibility for both iOS and Android users
- Backend Infrastructure:** Firebase for authentication, real-time database, and secure profile storage"
- Architecture:** Model-View-Controller (MVC) pattern with Provider for state management"
- Security:** JWT authentication with Firebase Security Rules for data protection"
- Development Process:** Agile methodology with bi-weekly sprints and continuous integration"

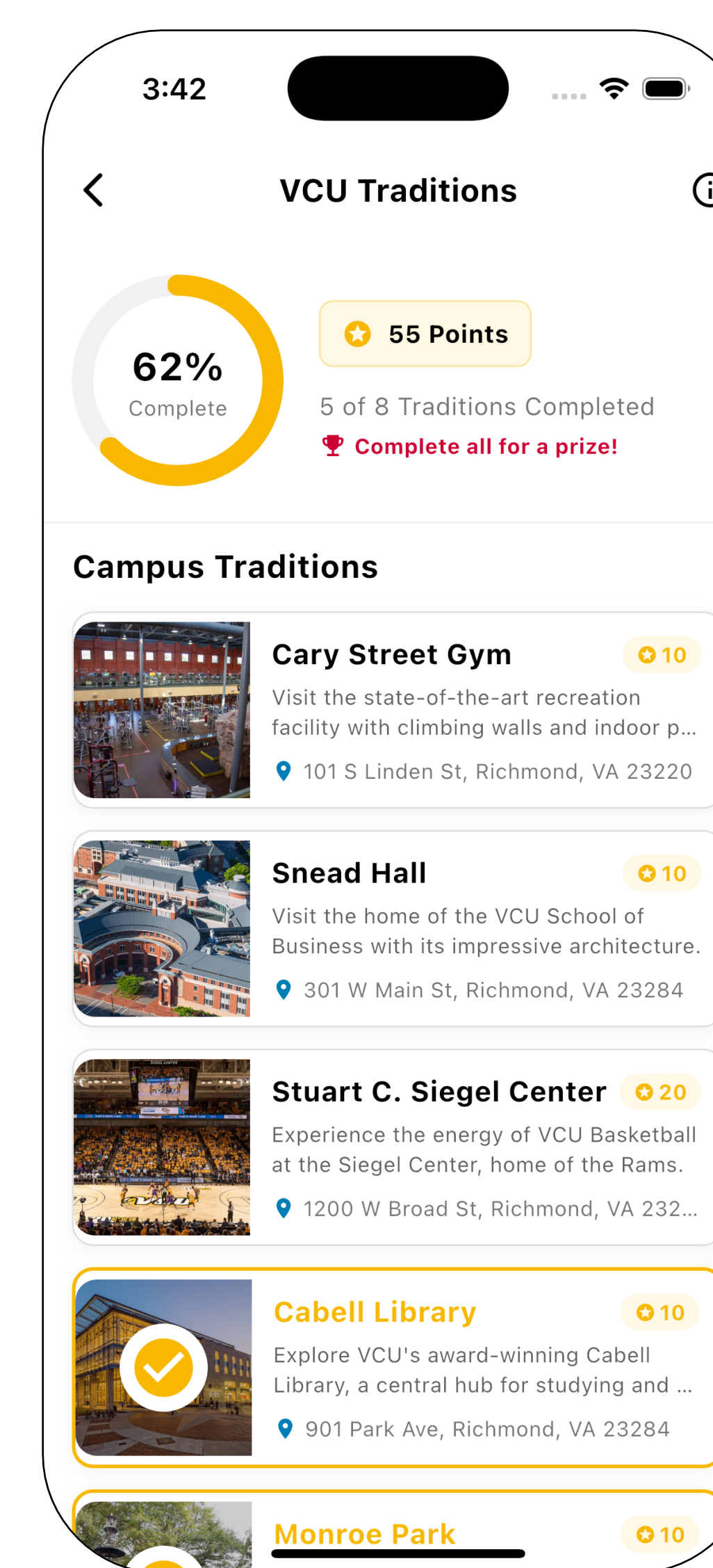
RAMily User Journey



Matching



Traditions



- Connect with fellow students based on shared academic and personal interests
- View detailed profiles with match percentages and common interests
- Send connection requests to start building meaningful relationships

- Explore iconic VCU locations through an interactive campus map
- Verify traditions using location-based checking
- Track progress with visual completion indicators and earn points for each completed tradition

Impact & Benefits

- For Students:**
 - Creates meaningful connections based on academic and personal interests
 - Simplifies exploration of VCU campus locations and traditions
 - Builds sense of belonging through guided community engagement
- For VCU:**
 - Supports student retention by fostering campus connections
 - Promotes university traditions and campus engagement
 - Provides scalable platform for student community building

Future Expansion

- Rambassadors:** Peer mentorship connecting new students with upperclassmen guides
- Academic Integration:** Study group formation for shared courses
- Events Hub:** Discovery and RSVP capabilities for campus activities
- Enhanced Gamification:** Achievement system with digital and physical rewards